

WILL JAMES

Developer for Agency & Marketing Teams — Code Meets Campaign

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PROFILE

Full-stack developer with an unusually direct line to the agency world: four years planning national media buys for clients like Kellogg's, Allstate, ESPN, and Visa before retraining as a developer and spending the last several years building and instrumenting the sites and tools that marketing teams run their campaigns on. Fluent in React, Vue, Angular, and WordPress/Drupal, and equally comfortable owning the Google Analytics and Tag Manager infrastructure a client's reporting depends on. Used to translating technical trade-offs into plain terms for non-technical stakeholders and juggling multiple concurrent projects on marketing-driven deadlines — built for freelance and contract work where the priorities shift client to client.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Front-End: JavaScript/TypeScript, React, Vue.js, Angular, jQuery, HTML/CSS, RESTful APIs

Marketing & Analytics: Google Tag Manager, Google Analytics, Looker Studio, Search Console, Crazy Egg, ad-server tagging, campaign reporting

Platforms & Back-End: WordPress, Drupal, PHP, .NET/C#, SQL Server, SpringBoot/STS

Also: CMS migrations, RPA-driven process automation, Git, Scrum/agile delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Associate Director, Digital Communications | Northwestern University — Alumni Relations *May 2022 – Apr 2025*

- Served as technical lead across concurrent MarComm initiatives, partnering directly with marketing strategists to turn campaign plans into shipped, working webpages on deadline.
- Owned the analytics stack end-to-end — built and maintained Google Tag Manager and custom Analytics implementations, then reported monthly in Looker Studio to inform stakeholder strategy.
- Led the technical side of a department-wide CMS migration to Cascade, sequencing the cutover to protect live traffic and lifting SiteImprove scores.

Web Developer & Digital Specialist | Northwestern University — Alumni Relations *Apr 2021 – May 2022*

- Built and maintained web pages focused on user engagement and accessibility; programmed a UiPath RPA robot to migrate 20,000+ digital assets with metadata fully intact.
- Implemented custom Google Tag Manager tracking (cookies, donation conversion) tied directly to measurable UX gains.

Full Stack Developer | Coca-Cola Bottling Consolidated *Sep 2019 – May 2020*

- Built, QA'd, and debugged an internal contract-execution and digital-signing app using C#/RESTful APIs and Angular, syncing daily with the team via Scrum stand-ups to hit sprint goals.

Media Planner | Midan Marketing *Sep 2018 – Feb 2019*

- Planned 2019 ad spend using partner performance data and creative A/B testing; negotiated traditional, digital, sponsorship, and event buys with vendors.
- Implemented ad-server HTML/JavaScript tags to track campaign metrics accurately — early hands-on overlap between the media and dev sides of the business.

Media Associate | Starcom Worldwide *Jan 2015 – Jan 2018*

- Stewarded TV, digital, social, and print buys for clients including Kellogg's, Allstate, ESPN, and Visa, and served as the team's go-to resource for eSports/gaming buys.
- Built competitive analysis and Nielsen Catalina-based targeting reports that shaped budget allocation, and trained new associates on TV/video systems.

Sales & Technical Specialist | Apple Store *Sep 2011 – Dec 2013*

- Translated technical jargon into plain terms for customers at the Genius Bar, a client-facing habit that still shapes how technical work gets communicated to non-technical stakeholders today.

EDUCATION

Full Stack Web Development Certificate — Tech Talent South, Charlotte, NC (2019)

B.A., Theatre — Davidson College, Davidson, NC (2011)